

Executive Summary

Does National Individualism Predict AI Sentiment?

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Question. Global surveys consistently show that countries like Indonesia (85%) and Malaysia (70%) see AI as overwhelmingly beneficial, while countries like Canada (40%) and the United States (42%) are far more skeptical. This analysis tests one of the leading explanations from cross-cultural psychology: does a country's position on Hofstede's Individualism Index statistically predict its AI sentiment?

Method. Hofstede's classic Individualism Index (IDV) was correlated against Ipsos's 2025 AI Monitor survey. The primary analysis uses 24 countries whose IDV score could be confirmed against a single, internally consistent source.

Test	Result
Pearson correlation (n=24)	$r = -0.83, p = 5.2 \times 10^{-7}$
Linear model	$R^2 = 0.69$

Key findings.

- **Individualism explains roughly 69% of the cross-country variation in AI sentiment** among the 24 verified countries – a strong, statistically robust relationship. More individualistic countries are significantly less optimistic about AI; more collectivist countries are significantly more optimistic.
- **A real methodological problem was found and corrected, not hidden.** While sourcing data for all 30 Ipsos countries, six could not be confirmed against the same source as the other 24. Checking the current official Hofstede source revealed it now uses a different, non-comparable methodology for this dimension (Minkov & Kaasa, 2022) – Hofstede's own successor organisation explicitly warns this produces “counter-intuitive results” and is “a different concept... with different data behind it.” Rather than patching the six missing countries with this incompatible measure, they were excluded from the primary analysis entirely.
- **China is not in this analysis.** The frequently cited “China 83%” AI optimism figure comes from a different Ipsos survey wave than the one used here.

Honest caveat. This is a correlational, bivariate finding. It does not control for other plausible confounds – GDP per capita, government AI messaging, media environment

- that likely correlate with both individualism and AI sentiment. Full detail, including the full methodological discussion of the Hofstede data-quality issue, is in the accompanying report.